



Flowers preserved in amber

Two 9.9 crore year old flowers were found perfectly preserved in amber in modern day Myanmar. <https://digit.in/mar22-15>



Robot patrol dogs in US

The US is testing robot patrol dogs in an effort to make border patrols autonomous. <https://digit.in/mar22-16>

OnePlus Nord CE 2 5G

A mixed bag

Back in 2020, OnePlus changed the rules of the game when it decided to launch the Nord series. With the original Nord, the company made its way back to a budget segment it gradually vacated a few years ago. And now, the company has launched the Nord CE 2. On paper, the phone offers a good price to performance ratio, along with a gorgeous design. But how does it perform in real life? Let's find out.

BUILD AND DISPLAY

OnePlus has a history of building good-looking phones, and the Nord CE 2 is no exception. It features clean lines and a glossy back. It has a raised camera module that protrudes quite a bit.

Because of the materials used on the device, the phone feels slippery in the hand, and its back panel is also a major smudge magnet. But because of the presence of a light-reflecting gradient pattern at the back, the effects of smudges are nullified a bit.

In the display department, the Nord 2 comes with a 6.43 inch 90Hz Fluid AMOLED display which performs as expected. The panel is HDR10+ certified and offers a peak brightness of 800 nits. The panel itself is par for the course and works well for all intents and purposes. It gets plenty bright – even under direct sunlight – and outputs vibrant and punchy colours.

PERFORMANCE

Under the hood of the Nord CE 2, we get the powerful Dimensity 900 mid-range SoC, which is paired to either 6GB or 8GB of RAM and 128GB of storage. This hardware interacts with a copy of Android 11 based OxygenOS 11. This combination of hardware and software ensures that the phone offers just about enough to handle day-to-day tasks with ease. In our time with the phone, there was no noticeable lag, and apps worked without hitches.



However, it was in the benchmarks department that the phone did leave a little to be desired. We ran benchmarks such as AnTuTu, Geekbench and 3DMark WildLife, and in all these tests, the results thrown up were a little underwhelming. In fact, all the benchmarks that we ran on the device proved one thing, the OnePlus Nord CE 2 is not even making the best use of the chipset at hand, with its scores lesser than the Oppo Reno 7 which also sports the same chipset underneath the hood.

Thankfully though, the phone's below-par performance in benchmarks is not carried over to gaming, where the device managed to run titles such as Call of Duty Mobile and Asphalt 9 Legends without any troubles.

CAMERAS

The OnePlus Nord CE 2 offers some decent hardware in the camera department. The phone has triple cameras on the back with a 64-megapixel primary camera, an 8-megapixel ultra-wide camera and a 2-megapixel macro lens completing the set-up. On the front, we have a 16-megapixel selfie camera.

The primary camera is capable of clicking some really good-looking pictures in daylight with a good detail and clarity. Backed by OnePlus' advanced photography algorithm, pictures clicked in daylight come with natural colours. This is also largely the case for the ultra-wide lens which manages to capture a good amount of details and the colour accuracy is on point.

Low light performance for both lenses is decent and the front camera does a decent job capturing accurate skin tones and details.

BATTERY

OnePlus has not only equipped the device with a big 4500mAh battery but also added support for its top-of-the-line 65W Warp Charge. After a full charge, the phone can generally last a day and a half on moderate use. To

give our readers an idea, in our video loop test, the Nord 2 managed around 9 hours of screen time at the loss of 40 per cent charge and for games such as Call of Duty Mobile 4 per cent battery drop after 20 minutes of use.

VERDICT

The OnePlus Nord CE 2 does not do anything outstanding. At this price point, there are other phones like the iQOO Z3 and the Realme 9 Pro+ that offer better value. But both these phones have their failing. What the Nord CE 2 does right is that it does not fail in any of department. Be it cameras, general performance or even gaming, it offers above-par results everywhere, thereby establishing itself as a good contender for your money.

—Sushant Talwar



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SPECIFICATIONS

WEIGHT: 173g | DISPLAY DIMENSIONS: 6.43-inches | DISPLAY RESOLUTION: 2400x1080 | OPERATING SYSTEM: OxygenOS based on Android 11 | CPU: MediaTek Dimensity 900 | GPU: ARM Mali-G68 MC4 | RAM: 6GB/8GB LPDDR4X | STORAGE: 128GB UFS2.2 | BATTERY: 4,500mAh | CHARGING: 65W SUPERVOOC | CAMERA: 64MP + 8MP + 2MP (Rear), 16MP (Front)

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